MILITARY SPECIFICATION

ESCALLOPED POTATOES WITH HAM, THERMOSTABILIZED, FOR MEAL, READY-TO-EAT

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This document covers thermostabilized escalloped potatoes with ham in flexible pouches for use as a component of the Meal, Ready-to-Eat, Individual and Meal, Flight Feeding, Individual.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents. Unless otherwise specified, the following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this document to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

MILITARY

MIL-P-44073 - Packaging and Thermoprocessing of Foods in Flexible Pouches

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: U.S. Army Natick Research, Development and Engineering Center, Natick, MA 01760-5014 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 8940

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MIL-STD-900 - Bacterial Standards for Starches, Flours, Cereals, Alimentary Pastes, Dry Milks, and Sugars Used in the Preparation of Thermostabilized Foods for the Armed Forces

(Copies of documents required by contractors in connection with specific acquisition functions should be obtained from the contracting activity or as directed by the contracting activity.)

OTHER GOVERNMENT DOCUMENTS

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder (21 CFR Parts 1-199)

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF AGRICULTURE (USDA)

U.S. Standards for Grades of Butter

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Dairy Standardization Section, Dairy Division Room 2750-S, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Washington, DC 20250.)

ENVIRONMENTAL PROTECTION AGENCY (EPA)

National Interim Primary Drinking Water Regulations

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Office of Drinking Water WH550, Environmental Protection Agency, Washington, DC 20460.)

2.2 Other publications. Unless otherwise specified, the following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this document to the extent specified herein.

ASSOCIATION OF OFFICIAL ANALYTICAL CHEMISTS (AOAC)

Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, 1111 North 19th Street, Suite 210, Arlington, VA 22209.)

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AMERICAN DEHYDRATED ONION AND GARLIC ASSOCIATION (ADOGA)

Official Standards and Methods of the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association for Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Products

(Application for copies should be addressed to American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association, 375 Sutter Street, Suite 700, San Francisco, CA 94108.)

NATIONAL ACADEMY OF SCIENCES

Food Chemicals Codex

(Application for copies should be addressed to the National Academy Press, 2101 Constitution Avenue, N.W., Washington, DC 20418.)

(Technical society and technical association documents are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document shall take precedence.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified in the contract or purchase order, a sample shall be subjected to the first article inspection (see 4.4, 6.1, and 6.2).

3.2 Ingredients. All ingredients shall be clean, sound, wholesome, and free from foreign material, evidence of rodent or insect infestation, extraneous material, off-odors, off-flavors, and off-colors.

3.2.1 Water. Water used for formulation, blanching, and washing shall conform to the National Interim Primary Drinking Water Regulations.

3.2.2 Ham, canned, or cooked. The ham shall be high commercial grade. The ham shall not be labeled "water added," and shall not contain dextrose. The canned or cooked hams shall be maintained in the temperature range of 28°F to 40°F for a period of time not to exceed 60 days from data of pack until preparation of the finished product.

3.2.3 Potatoes, fresh. The potatoes shall be fresh, firm and of a white flesh variety suitable for canning. The maximum specific gravity for the potatoes shall be 1.075 with a reducing sugar content of not more than 2.0 percent on a dry weight basis.

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3.2.4 Potatoes, diced, dehydro-frozen. The dehydro-frozen potatoes shall be firm, have a good color and flavor and be of a white flesh variety suitable for canning. The maximum specific gravity for the potatoes shall be 1.075 with a reducing sugar content of not more than 2.0 percent on a dry-weight basis. The potatoes shall be of the latest season's crop. The potatoes shall be mechanically diced to approximately 3/8 by 3/8 by 1/2 inch dimensions.

3.2.5 Shortening, vegetable, powdered. The powdered vegetable shortening shall consist of components which, when combined, will serve as a product whitening agent. The powdered shortening, when used as an ingredient in this product, shall withstand the conditions of thermoprocessing specified in this document without browning. A typical analysis of this powdered shortening follows:

Fat	75.00 percent	±1.50 percent
Protein	5.50 percent	±0.50 percent
Carbohydrates	15.00 percent	±1.00 percent
Moisture	2.00 percent	Maximum

3.2.6 Starch, modified, high opacity. The high opacity starch shall be white, odorless, finely pulverized modified maize food starch for use in canned foods and shall comply with MIL-STD-900. The modified starch shall demonstrate initial viscosity development in the temperature range of 140° to 170°F and a typical viscosity (be fully hydrated) at common retort temperatures. It shall resist breakdown at low pH, under shear stress and conditions of cold storage. The cooked modified starch slurry shall be bland with essentially no cereal or starch taste.

3.2.7 Butter, lightly salted. The lightly salted butter shall be U.S. Grade A or better of the U.S. Standards for Grades of Butter.

3.2.8 Lecithin. Lecithin shall comply with the Food Chemicals Codex.

3.2.9 Onion, powder. Onion powder shall be Fancy Grade of the Official Standards and Methods of the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association (ADOGA) for Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Products.

3.2.10 Pepper, white, ground. Ground white pepper shall be derived from the dried mature berries of Piper nigrum L. from which the outer covering or the outer and inner coverings have been removed. The ground white pepper shall have a characteristic, penetrating odor, a hot biting pungent flavor, and a light color. The ground white pepper shall contain not less than 1.0 mL of volatile oil per 100 grams of ground white pepper and be of such size that not less than 95 percent shall pass through a U.S. Standard No. 40 sieve.

3.2.11 Celery seed, ground. Ground celery seed shall be prepared from the seed of Apium graveolens L. The ground celery seed shall be light to rich

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brown in color and possess a characteristic celery odor and flavor with a warm slightly bitter aftertaste. The celery seed shall contain not less than 2.0 mL of volatile oil per 100 grams and be of such size that not less than 95 percent shall pass through a U.S. standard No. 55 sieve.

3.2.12 Preblended spice and seasoning mixture. Preblended spices and seasonings may be used. The spices and seasonings in the mixture shall comply with the requirements of this document. The containers used for the spice and seasoning blend shall be labeled with each ingredient and the percentage of each ingredient in the blend. The ingredients shall be in the same proportions as specified in the ingredient formula.

3.2.1.3 Starch, filling and processing aid (see 6.3). The filling and processing aid shall be white, odorless, finely pulverized, modified waxy maize starch for use as a filling and processing aid in canned, retorted foods and shall comply with MIL-STD-900. During retort temperatures of 165°F to 200°F, the starch shall form a clear, bland paste that retains its initial high viscosity under conditions of moderate shear and prolonged holding times. During the retort process the starch shall thin out and lend no appreciable viscosity to the final product.

3.3 Preparation and processing. Processing shall be on a continuous basis.

3.3.1 Preparation of ham. The ham shall be diced into approximately 3/8 by 3/8 by 1/2 to 3/4 inch dices. The dices shall be cooked in a steam jacketed kettle at a temperature and time to produce a 25 to 30 percent cook-out of broth without scorching the ham dices. The broth shall be drained from the cooked ham. Immediately after cooking, the ham dices and broth shall be utilized in the product (see 3.3.4 and 3.3.5). If this cannot be accomplished immediately, the cooked ham dices and ham broth shall be rapidly cooled down to a temperature range of 28° to 40°F and held in this range for not more than 48 hours before being utilized in the sauce or product preparation.

3.3.2 Preparation of potatoes.

3.3.2.1 Preparation of fresh potatoes. The fresh potatoes shall be washed, sorted, peeled and trimmed. The potatoes shall be mechanically diced to approximately 3/8 by 3/8 by 1/2 to 3/4 inch dimensions, and the dices blanched sufficiently to prevent discoloration and to remove excess air. The blanched potatoes shall be cooled rapidly to 45°F or lower by washing with cold water and held at a temperature of 45°F or below for not longer than 4 hours after blanching and in a manner to prevent discoloration prior to product preparation.

3.3.2.2 Preparation of dehydrofrozen potatoes. The dehydrofrozen potatoes shall be used without further preparation and handled in a manner to prevent discoloration prior to product preparation.

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3.3.3 Preparation of filling and processing aid starch. A solution (slurry) shall be prepared with the filling and processing aid starch and cold water in a concentration adequate to hold ingredients in suspension for uniform distribution during mixing and pumping of product.

3.3.4 Preparation of sauce. The sauce shall be formulated and prepared as follows:

Ingredient 1/	Percent by weight
Water and ham broth	89.43
Powdered vegetable shortening	4.00
Starch, modified	3.50
Butter	2.00
Lecithin	0.25
Onion powder	0.75
Pepper, white, ground	0.06
Celery seed, ground	0.01

1/ The total amount of salt in the sauce formula shall be adjusted as necessary to produce a product which complies with the finished product salt requirements (see 3.6).

a. A slurry shall be made using part of the formula water, the starch and the powdered vegetable shortening.

b. The balance of the ingredients shall be heated to 180° to 190°F.

c. The slurry shall be added and the sauce vigorously stirred until the temperature reaches 150° to 170°F.

d. The volume of the sauce shall be adjusted with water to compensate for evaporation during heating and holding.

e. The sauce shall be filled within 4 hours after cooking. A filling and processing aid starch solution may be added in the amount required to facilitate uniform ingredient distribution in single-stage filling operations when dehydrofrozen potatoes are used. If a hot fill method is used, the prepared sauce shall be held in the temperature range of 150°F to 180°F at all times prior to filling into the pouches. If a cold fill method is used, the prepared sauce shall be cooled immediately and held within a temperature range of 28°F to 40°F at all times prior to filling into the pouches.

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3.3.5 Product preparation. The product shall contain the following proportions of ingredients:

a. When using fresh potatoes:

Ingredient	Percent by weight
Diced ham	37.5
Diced potatoes	25.0
Sauce	37.5

b. When using dehydrofrozen potatoes:

Ingredient	Percent by weight
Diced ham	37.5
Diced potatoes	12.5
Sauce	37.5
Water	12.5

3.4 Pouch filling and sealing. Each pouch shall be filled with product such as to conform to the finished product requirements and to the following requirements:

a. Each pouch shall be filled and sealed in accordance with the pouch filling and sealing requirements for class 3 as specified in MIL-P-44073.

b. A hot fill system is permitted if compatible with the single-stage or multi-stage filling and sealing method used.

c. The temperature of the ham, potatoes and sauce at time of filling shall be as specified (see 3.3.1, 3.3.2 and 3.3.4) for the applicable filling process used.

d. The ingredients may be filled into the pouch using either a single-stage or multi-stage filling operation.

e. Each filled and sealed pouch shall be in the retort process within 1 hour after sealing.

3.5 Pouch thermoprocessing. The filled and sealed pouches shall be thermostabilized by retorting until a sterilization value (F_o) of not less than 6 has been achieved. The thermoprocessing operation shall be in compliance with the thermoprocessing requirements for class 3 of MIL-P-44073.

3.6 Finished product requirements. The finished product shall comply with the following requirements:

a. There shall be no foreign material, such as, but not limited to, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, paper, paint, glass, or metal.

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b. There shall be no foreign odor or flavor, such as, but not limited to, burnt, scorched, stale, sour, rancid, musty, or moldy.

c. There shall be no color foreign to the product.

d. There shall be no bone pieces measuring more than 0.3 inch in any dimension.

e. There shall be no cartilage, coarse connective tissue, or section of tendons or ligaments measuring more than 0.3 inch in any dimension.

f. There shall be no skin, blood clot, or bruised or discolored meat measuring more than 0.3 inch in any dimension.

g. The average net weight shall be not less than 8.0 ounces.

h. No individual pouch shall contain less than 7.5 ounces of product.

i. No individual pouch shall contain less than 2.5 ounces of drained ham.

j. The average drained weight of the ham in pouches shall be not less than 3.0 ounces.

k. No individual pouch shall contain less than 1.5 ounces of drained potatoes.

l. The average drained weight of the potatoes in pouches shall not be less than 2.0 ounces.

m. At least 75 percent of the ham shall be discernible dices which measure approximately 3/8 by 3/8 by 1/2 to 3/4 inches.

n. Texture of the ham dices shall not be dry, rubbery, or mushy.

o. Texture of the potatoes shall not be hard, rubbery, fibrous, or mushy.

p. Sauce consistency shall be smooth, without lumps, and shall not be excessively thick or thin.

q. The average fat content shall not be greater than 8.0 percent.

r. No individual pouch of product shall have a fat content greater than 8.0 percent.

s. No individual pouch of product shall have a salt content greater than 1.2 percent or less than 0.5 percent.

t. The product shall show no evidence of excessive heating (materially darkened, scorched).

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3.6.1 Palatability. The product shall be equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample (see 6.1) in palatability and overall appearance.

3.7 Plant qualification. The ham component and the finished product shall originate and be produced, processed, and stored in plants regularly operating under Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations of the U.S. Department of Agriculture.

3.8 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Contractor's responsibility. Inspection and acceptance by the USDA shall not relieve the contractor of obligation and responsibility to deliver a product complying with all requirements of this document. The contractor shall assure product compliance prior to submitting the product to the USDA for any inspection.

4.2 Inspection and certification. Product acceptability shall be determined by USDA. The USDA will determine the degree of supervision necessary to assure compliance with the requirements of this document.

4.3 Classification of inspection. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.4).
b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.5).

4.4 First article inspection. When a first article is required (see 6.1), it shall be inspected in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of this document and evaluated for overall appearance and palatability. Any failure to conform to the quality assurance provisions of this document or any appearance or palatability failure shall be cause for rejection of the first article.

4.5 Quality conformance inspection. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.5.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced documents unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this document or applicable purchase document.

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4.5.1.1 Ingredient and component examination. Conformance of ingredients and components to identity, condition, and other requirements specified in 3.2 shall be certified by the ingredient supplier or ingredient manufacturer, or compliance be evident by examination of pertinent labels, markings, U.S. Grade Certificates, certificates of analyses, or other such valid documents acceptable to the inspection agency. In addition, prior to use, each ingredient shall be examined organoleptically, as necessary, to determine conformance to the condition requirements. Any nonconformance to an identity, condition, or other requirement shall be cause for rejection of the ingredient or component lot or of any involved product.

4.5.2 In-process examination. In-process examination shall be performed to determine conformance to the preparation, processing, filling, sealing and packaging requirements. Any nonconformance revealed by actual examination or by review of records of time, temperature, and formulation or of other valid documents shall be cause for rejection of the involved products.

4.5.3 Filled and sealed pouch inspection. Inspection of filled and sealed pouches shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of MIL-P-44073.

4.5.4 Net weight inspection. The net weight of the filled and sealed pouches shall be determined by weighing each sample unit on a suitable scale, tared with a representative empty pouch. Any individual net weight of less than 7.5 ounces shall be scored as a minor defect. The lot size shall be expressed in pouches. The sample unit shall be one filled and sealed pouch. The inspection level shall be S-3 and the acceptable quality level (AQL), expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5. Results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 ounce. In addition, the lot shall be rejected if the sample average net weight is less than 8.0 ounces.

4.5.5 Product inspection. The filled and sealed sample pouches shall be held for a minimum of 72 hours at room temperature (65° to 75°F) after completion of the thermoprocessing operation. The pouches shall be heated in boiling water for 10 minutes, opened, and inspected for the defects indicated in table I. The lot size shall be expressed in pouches. The sample unit shall be the contents of one pouch. The inspection level shall be S-3 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 1.5.

TABLE I. Product defects 1/ 2/

Category	Defect
Major	
101	Presence of bone measuring more than 0.3 inch in any direction.
102	Presence of cartilage, coarse connective tissue, or section of tendons or ligaments measuring more than 0.3 inch in any dimension.

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TABLE I. Product defects 1/ 2/ (cont'd)

Category	Defect
Major	
103	Presence of skin, blood clot, bruise, or discolored meat measuring more than 0.3 inch in any dimension.
104	Drained weight of ham dices in a pouch less than 2.5 ounces. 3/ 4/
105	Drained weight of potatoes in a pouch is less than 1.5 ounces. 3/ 5/
106	Less than 75 percent of the ham consists of dicernible dices measuring approximately 3/8 by 3/8 by 1/2 to 3/4 inches. 6/
107	Texture of ham dices is dry, rubbery or mushy. 6/
108	Texture of potatoes is hard, rubbery, fibrous or mushy. 6/
109	Sauce consistency is lumpy or is excessively thick or thin.
110	Product shows evidence of excess heating (materially darkened or scorched).

1/ The presence of foreign material (e.g., gloss, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, metal), foreign odor or flavor (e.g., burnt, scorched, moldy, rancid, sour, stale, etc.), or foreign color shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

2/ Product not equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample (see 6.1) in palatability and overall appearance shall be cause for rejection of the lot. This comparison shall be performed only when deemed necessary by the AMS agent.

3/ To determine drained weight, the free liquid in the pouch shall be poured off and remaining contents shall be poured into a flat bottom container. A minimum of three times the pouch's volume of 190° to 212°F water shall be added to the container so as to cover the contents. The contents and water shall be gently agitated such as to liquify rendered fat and to remove the sauce without breaking the ham dices or potatoes. The contents shall then be poured onto a U.S. Standard 1/4-inch sieve in a manner that

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will distribute the product over the sieve without breaking the ham dices or potatoes. Sieve area shall be such that the distributed product does not completely cover all the openings of the sieve. The sieve shall be tilted at an approximate 45° angle and allowed to drain for 2 minutes. Record the gross weight of the ham dices and potatoes. Remove the ham dices. Reweigh and record the gross weight of potatoes. Subtract sieve tare weight to calculate the drained weights of ham dices and potatoes and report to the nearest 0.1 ounce.

4/ If the sample average drained weight of the ham is less than 3.0 ounces, the lot shall be rejected.

5/ If the sample average drained weight of the potatoes is less than 2.0 ounces, the lot shall be rejected.

6/ Examination for appearance and texture conformance of the ham dices and potatoes shall be made of representative pieces immediately following the determination of drained weight.

4.5.6 Fat and salt content testing. The unopened sample pouches shall be warmed in a water bath to melt fat adhering to the inside of the pouches. The sample pouches shall be opened and the entire contents of each pouch shall be separately blended in a Waring blender or equivalent. The fat and salt content of the product from each pouch in the sample shall be determined in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, Chapter: Meat and Meat Products. Test results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 percent. Any result failing to conform to the fat or salt requirement in 3.6 shall be classified as a major defect. The lot size shall be expressed in pouches. The sample unit shall be one filled and sealed pouch. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 1.5.

4.5.7 Packaging inspection. Inspection of packaging shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of MIL-P-44073.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be in accordance with the applicable requirements of MIL-P-44073.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this document.
b. When a first article is required (see 3.1, 4.4 and 6.2).
c. Provisions for approved preproduction samples (see 3.6.1 and 6.2).

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6.2 First article. When a first article is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of FAR 52.209. The first article should be a preproduction sample. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in all acquisition documents regarding arrangements for selection, inspection, and approval of the first article.

6.3 Starch, filling and processing aid. Shur-Fil ® CS-500 starch, A.E. Staley Mfg. Co., Decatur, IL 62525 has been found to be satisfactory in holding ingredients in suspension for uniform distribution during mixing and pumping of product for single-stage filling operations.

Custodians:

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 50

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Project No. 8940-0520

Review activities:

Army - MD, TS
Navy - MC, MS
DP - SS

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-E-44200	Escalloped Potatoes with Ham, Thermostabilized, For Meal, Ready-to-Eat

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ VENDOR ☐ USER ☐ MANUFACTURER ☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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